

The Reporting & Investigation of Accidents/Incidents & Near Miss Events



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1. Introduction

This policy outlines the procedures that are to be adopted when any employee, visitor or contractor experiences an accident or near-miss on Fox Group premises.

It is the policy of the company to investigate accidents and their underlying causes. To enable this objective to be achieved it is imperative that all accidents and near misses, whatever the level of the resulting injury or damage, be reported according to this procedure.

Accidents and Near-misses as defined as follows:

Accident: Undesired circumstance(s) which gives rise to ill health, injury, damage, production losses or increased liabilities.

Near-miss: An event that, while not causing harm, has the potential to cause injury or ill health. Examples of near misses include: nearly hitting someone with a moving vehicle or plant item, items falling near to personnel, overturning plant, however we encourage the reporting of anything which, as a valued employee, you feel is unsafe or not quite right –

“If in doubt, give us a shout!”

Often the difference between a near miss and an accident is pure chance, which is why learning from these events is just as vital as learning from injury accidents but with the benefit of being before any injury is caused.

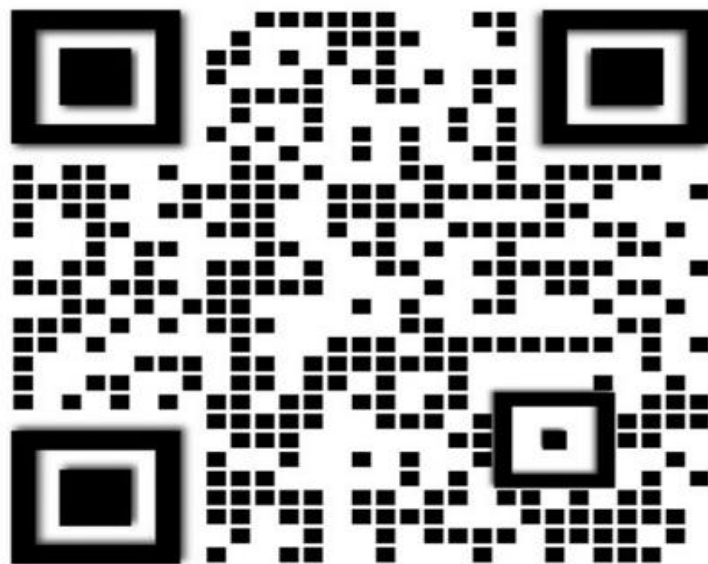
2. e-Accident Books

The company utilises a HSE compliant electronic accident book which is accessed by means of scanning a QR code (fig.1.), every depot must display the QR code in prominent places with all staff and any new starters shown how to access and use the e-accident book. All accidents occurring on company premises must be recorded utilising company's e-accident book, whether they occur to an employee, contractor, visitor etc.



Accident Report Book

Report all **Accidents** through the QR code below.



**ALL INJURIES, HOWEVER SMALL, MUST
BE REPORTED**

Fig.1.

Should a FOX GROUP employee be injured on businesses premises not controlled by Fox Group, the accident must be reported in the accident book of that business. Where the accident is reportable under the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations, (RIDDOR), 2013, it is FOX GROUP's responsibility to notify the HSE within the specified time once the employee, or business responsible for the premises, has notified Fox Group.

A review of reported accidents and near misses will be undertaken regularly by senior management to ascertain the nature of incidents which have occurred in the workplace. This review will be in addition to an individual investigation of the circumstances surrounding each incident.

3. Accident Reporting Procedure

In the case of personal injury accidents, this reporting procedure is to be instigated after initial first aid / emergency service help has been summoned and administered to the injured party where required.

1. All accidents must be reported to the Depot Manager.
2. Accident details must be entered in the e-Accident Book either by the injured person or, if this is not practical, someone else present at the time.
3. Once the completed the e-accident book entry will automatically inform the FoxSafe HSE team.
4. The Depot Manager should make sure the area is made safe if required, to prevent further injury to others. If it is suspected that the accident is RIDDOR reportable (see section 5 below) the depot manager should liaise with the FoxSafe HSE team who will help clarify whether
 - a. the accident is RIDDOR reportable
 - b. the FoxSafe HSE team and/or the enforcing authorities will require that the site is kept unaltered for investigation.
5. The Depot Manager will usually be available immediately at the site, be familiar with the surroundings and therefore best placed to promptly begin an investigation into the cause of the accident through completion of the H&S Incident Investigation Report form on the FoxSafe - Safety Culture App. A prompt will be sent by the FoxSafe team on receipt of the e-Accident report.

6. Additional investigative resources will be provided by the FoxSafe HSE Team for any accidents requiring detailed investigations into root cause analysis and or where incidents have resulted in severe injury.
7. The FoxSafe Safety Culture app allows for information to be shared immediately with the FoxSafe HSE team and where applicable the senior management within the operating company and Fox Group.

The FoxSafe HSE Team will:

1. Review the initial H&S Incident Investigation Report to consider if further investigation is required.
2. Manage the investigations for more serious or complex incidents requiring detailed root cause analysis or that have resulted in serious injuries.
3. Ensure the requirements of the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations, (RIDDOR), 2013 are met where applicable.
4. Report findings to the Group HSE Director as well as the operating companies management.
5. Ensure HR has been informed that the accident occurred to enable their procedures to be implemented.
6. Following a full review, the FoxSafe HSE team will then ensure, so far as reasonably practicable, that proper action is taken to help prevent the accident being repeated, and any amendments to Risk Assessments will be communicated to all members of staff.
7. A Root Cause Analysis will additionally be undertaken if Senior management believe further investigation is required to establish the cause of a particular issue and to identify appropriate solutions.

4. Near Miss reporting

All near-misses should be reported to the Fox Safe HSE Team via the Near miss reporting QR code (Fig.2.) as soon as possible so that appropriate action can be taken including, where applicable a full and frank investigation the causes in order to prevent recurrence.

NEAR MISS REPORT FORM

SCAN THE QR

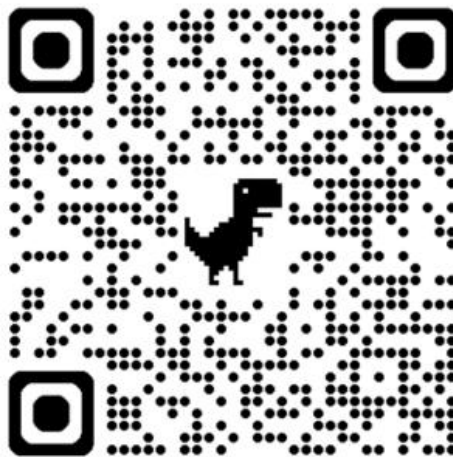


Fig.2.

All individuals are encouraged to report anything which they feel is unsafe, whether or not what they observe falls neatly into the category of near miss as defined above. Once received the FoxSafe Team will decide how best to respond to any such report

Fox Group operates a zero blame procedure for near miss reporting and investigations, the purpose of which is ensure near misses are reported without fear of disciplinary action, rather the purpose of near miss investigations are to determine what went wrong and why and what needs to be done to prevent an accident in the future through examining processes, procedures, levels of training, competence and supervision.

Near miss reporting procedure

1. When a near miss or any thing which an employee considers to be unsafe is observed the employee should scan the *"If in doubt, give us a shout!"* QR code
2. The QR code will take the employee to the FoxSafe Safety Culture app web page where they will be able to select the appropriate site – listed by operating company
3. The report form requires a brief summary of what has been observed and gives the opportunity to input photos and or videos of the near miss or unsafe event/activity or action
4. If the report is regarding an issue found outside of the company's fixed sites then more details can be provided as to the location, although location data from the reporters phone will be automatically uploaded.
5. All reports can be made anonymously however if the individual wishes to get feedback on the progress of their report then they can input their contact details.
6. Once received by the FoxSafe HSE team a review of the report will be made to determine if, and at what level, an investigation is required. In some instances the Manager responsible for the location will be tasked to conduct an investigation into the report using the H&S Incident Investigation report (NMIR01). In instances whereby a more thorough examination into the root causes are required then a HSE Manager from the FoxSafe HSE will conduct the investigation and report on any necessary improvement to be made which will be consulted on and implemented Group wide.

5. RIDDOR 2013

The full detail of the requirements under RIDDOR 2013 can be found in numerous places, including the references at the end of this document. All reports, except for deaths and major injury, should be made using the appropriate online form. For reporting purposes the following apply:

Death & Injury:

Any death or major injury at work must be reported to the HSE by the 'quickest practicable means, i.e. by calling their contact line, available on their website.

Since April 2012, a record must be kept of any accident causing a worker to be incapacitated for more than three consecutive days, (not counting the day in which the accident happened). However it is not RIDDOR reportable until the employee has been incapacitated for more than 7 consecutive days. Further reports shall be made if the injury is a specified injury under the regulations. The report must be made within 15 days of the accident.

Occupational diseases:

Employers must report listed occupational diseases when they receive a written diagnosis from a doctor that their employee is suffering from these conditions and the sufferer has been doing the work activities listed.

Dangerous occurrences:

Dangerous occurrences are certain near-miss events, the types of which are specifically listed. Not every near-miss event must be reported, but those that should be must be reported within 10 days of occurrence.

6. Summary

Clearly it is essential for all concerned to give priority to the safety and welfare of any injured person and anyone else involved. The above is simply the administrative procedure to deal with accidents after they have occurred which is why reporting and learning from near miss events is so important.

7. References

- Health & Safety Executive (HSE), *'Investigating Accidents and Incidents; a workbook for employers, unions, safety representatives and safety professionals'*, 2004, HSE Leaflet HSG245, Second Edition, Reprinted 2014.
- Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations (1999)
- Reporting of Injuries, Diseases & Dangerous Occurrences Regulations (2013)
- Health & Safety Executive (HSE), *'A brief guide to the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations 2013 (RIDDOR) – INDG453*